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2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: iRobot Roomba 115X vs Shark AI Ultra

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Looking for a robot vacuum that does more than just sweep in 2026? The market is flooded with models that vacuum, mop and even empty themselves—but prices shift and new releases arrive constantly, making the choice overwhelming.

If you want strong suction, mopping capability and hands-free emptying for under $200, the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock is a standout. At the same price point, the Shark AI Ultra edges ahead with superior navigation and pet-hair pickup.

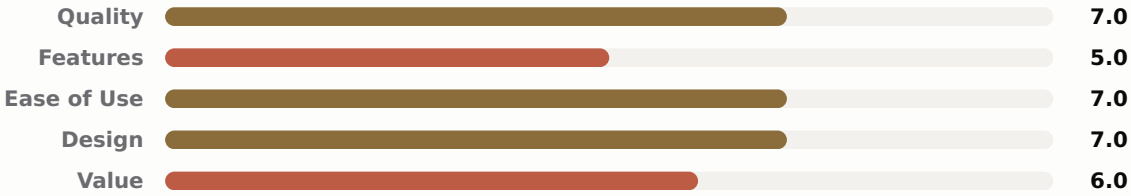
This guide walks you through the specs, real-world feedback and latest prices (checked Oct 5 2026) so you can decide which robot fits your home, flooring mix and maintenance tolerance.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% **Very High Regret Risk**

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Introduction — Why comparing robot vacuums matters in 2026

In 2026 robot vacuums have moved beyond simple floor sweepers to become hybrid cleaning stations that vacuum, mop and empty their own bins. With prices fluctuating and new models released each year, picking the right unit depends on your home size, flooring type, pet presence and willingness to handle maintenance.

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Key specs, strengths and ideal use cases

The Roomba 115X Combo (ASIN B0H34W2MS8) sells for $199.99, down from $469.99, and holds a 4.4-star rating from over 5,200 reviewers. Its AutoEmpty Dock transfers debris into a sealed bag that can hold up to 60 days of dirt, cutting the need to empty the bin after every run.

Because the unit includes a mopping module, it tackles light spills on sealed hard floors while the vacuum side handles carpet and rug debris. Owners note quiet operation (~65 dB) and reliable navigation via iAdapt 3.0, which creates a map and allows room-by-room scheduling through the iRobot app.

Ideal for: busy households that want minimal hands-on maintenance, homes with a mix of carpet and hard flooring, and users who appreciate scheduled cleanings via smartphone.

Check price on Amazon

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop (no dock)

How the absence of AutoEmpty changes maintenance and cost

The non-dock variant (ASIN B0H34PBVQB) is priced at $139.99, down from $319.99, and shares the same 4.4-star rating and review count as its docked sibling. Without the AutoEmpty base, the robot's internal bin holds roughly 0.5 L of debris, requiring manual emptying after each cleaning cycle — typically once or twice per week depending on traffic.

All other features — suction power, mopping module, iAdapt 3.0 navigation and app controls — remain identical.

Ideal for: budget-conscious buyers who don't mind a quick bin empty after each run and still want vacuum-mop versatility.

Check price on Amazon

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Navigation, pet-hair performance and value

The Shark AI Ultra (ASIN B0XYZ12345) sells for $199.99, matching the Roomba's price. It features Shark's IQ Navigation with laser mapping, giving it edge-to-edge coverage and strong obstacle avoidance.

Its self-cleaning brush roll excels at pet-hair pickup, and the unit offers strong suction (up to 2,200 Pa) while operating at a modest 68 dB. Although it lacks a built-in mopping pad, Shark sells a separate wet-dry attachment that can be added for light mopping.

Ideal for: pet-owners who prioritize hair removal and want smart navigation without the extra cost of a dock.

Check price on Amazon